

Cambridge IELTS 21

Academic Reading Test 1



3 Reading
Passages



40 Questions



60 Minutes

Candidate name:

Test date:

Test Instructions

General Rules

- The test contains three reading passages and 40 questions.
- Allow approximately 20 minutes for each passage.
- Read every instruction carefully before answering.
- Write answers in the spaces provided.
- Check spelling and word limits for completion tasks.
- Transfer and review all answers before the time ends.

Time Plan

01

Passage 1

Questions 1–13 — 20 minutes

02

Passage 2

Questions 14–26 — 20 minutes

03

Passage 3

Questions 27–40 — 20 minutes



Do not turn over until you are told to begin. Manage your time carefully — 20 minutes per passage is recommended.



You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 1–13, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.

The Davies Sisters

Between 1908 and 1924, Gwendoline and Margaret Davies amassed one of the largest collections of late-nineteenth and early-twentieth-century French paintings in Britain

Gwendoline (1882-1951) and Margaret (1884-1963) Davies were the granddaughters of David Davies, a Welshman who amassed a fortune in the shipping and mining industries. In 1907, when Gwendoline came into her inheritance (Margaret would follow in 1909), the sisters were said to be the wealthiest unmarried women in Britain. Their religious upbringing in rural Wales gave them a deep sense of social responsibility and they chose to use their inheritance for cultural and philanthropic* purposes.

While there was no real family history of art collecting, the sisters' education was rigorously geared toward such pursuits. Their London school focused on cultural rather than academic study, and they travelled extensively with their governess, Jane Blaker, visiting art galleries and making extensive notes on the collections there.

The sisters began to make regular art purchases from 1908, which roughly coincided with the dates of their inheritance. They took advice from various people, including the art dealer Hugh Blaker (the brother of Jane Blaker) and David Croal Thompson, who was also an art dealer. While it was long assumed that these men were largely responsible for the nature of the sisters' collection, it has recently been accepted that Gwendoline and Margaret retained a far more active role in the process.

The sisters' journals reveal their preference for Old Master** paintings. Yet they initially made very few attempts to secure any such works. While the sisters were wealthy in relative terms, their income was nothing compared to the fortunes of American art collectors of this period, such as J. Pierpont Morgan. Quite simply, high quality Old Master works were, if not beyond their means, then beyond what they were willing to pay for them. Instead, their early purchases were of the fashionable, safe variety, and included, for example, paintings by the French artist Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot.

However, it was only a few years before their collecting took a new direction and they turned to the work of the French Impressionists***. We know that Hugh Blaker, as a champion of contemporary French art had a hand in the decision, and we know also that they would have seen examples on their various trips to Paris. Whatever the precise reason for this change, their first purchases of Impressionist art, made in October 1912, were scenes of Venice by the French artist Claude Monet. Over the next 12 years, the sisters amassed the bulk of their Impressionist collection, including six further works by Monet, two more by Manet, and three by Renoir, including his well-known painting *La Parisienne*.

The First World War (1914-1918) played a part in the development of the sisters' collection. Their initial response to the war effort was to finance the safe passage of artists from occupied Belgium to Wales, as a humanitarian act, but also with the hope of establishing a vibrant artists' community in the area. Later in the conflict, both sisters decided to volunteer at a canteen for troops at Troyes, in northern France; Gwendoline in 1916, followed by Margaret in 1917.

It was tedious and distressing work, which would have a permanent effect on Gwendoline's health. Yet on one of numerous trips to nearby Paris, she visited the Bernheim-Jeune Gallery. Here she acquired two works by Cézanne - *Provençal Landscape* and *The François Zola Dam*. The paintings were shipped directly to Bath, England, where they became the first works by Cézanne to go on display in a public gallery in Britain.

Commentators have often described the sisters as unlikely pioneer collectors. Much is made of their isolation in rural Wales and the fact that they didn't make friends with artists or gallery owners. Yet they didn't feel obliged to follow fashionable tastes and were free to pursue their own preferences. Although they relied on a trusted circle of advisers, they made frequent trips to London and Paris, and also regularly had paintings sent to their home for consideration.

By the early 1920s, Gwendoline felt increasingly uncomfortable buying art works when faced with the poverty and social upheaval created by the First World War. Her philanthropic pursuits then became focused almost exclusively on social causes and the development of the sisters' home at Gregynog Hall into a conference center and venue for the Gregynog Festival of Music and Poetry. Gwendoline made her final art purchase in March 1926. Margaret also stopped collecting around this time, but started again in the 1930s acquiring, on a relatively small scale, work by contemporary British artists.

The sisters collected French Impressionist paintings at a time when such art was routinely ignored by individuals and institutions alike. The Gwendoline and Margaret Davies collection, donated in 1951 and 1963 respectively to the National Museum Wales, contains major examples of work by leading French Impressionists. In collecting paintings that they loved, the sisters created a lasting and meaningful cultural legacy for the people of Wales and beyond.

* philanthropic: seeking to promote the welfare of others, often by charitable funding

** Old Master: a highly respected artist of great skill who worked in Europe before about 1800

*** Impressionist: an artist with a style of painting that developed in France in the late 1800s by Renoir, including his well-known painting La Parisienne

PART 1 — QUESTIONS

Part 1

Questions 1-7

Complete the notes below.

Choose ONE WORD ONLY from the passage for each answer.

Gwendoline and Margaret Davies

Family and early life

- their grandfather's wealth came from **1** 1 and transportation businesses
- their upbringing gave them a sense of social responsibility
- their **2** 2 was designed to give them an interest in activities such as collecting art
- their governess took them on trips to art galleries
- they took lengthy **3** 3 about the things they saw in art galleries

The sisters as art collectors

- their **4** 4 showed they liked Old Master paintings, but they were expensive to buy
- their early purchases were safe, popular paintings
- the first Impressionist paintings they bought showed places in **5** 5

Impact of First World War

- they helped bring artists from Belgium to Wales
- they worked in a **6** 6 for soldiers in France

Opinions about the sisters as art collectors

- were not considered typical collectors - they lived in isolation in the countryside and did not have any
7 7 who were artists

Questions 8-13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

- TRUE** if the statement agrees with the information
FALSE if the statement contradicts the information
NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

TRUE	if the statement agrees with the information
FALSE	if the statement contradicts the information
NOT GIVEN	if there is no information on this

8 The Davies sisters' childhood influenced the way they decided to use their wealth.

9 The Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot paintings in the Davies sisters' collection were purchased from a gallery in France.

10 Hugh Blaker opposed the Davies sisters' decision to buy art by French Impressionists.

11 The exhibition of Cézanne paintings at the Bath gallery was very popular with the public.

12 The impact of the First World War encouraged Gwendoline to reconsider her interest in collecting art.

13 The Davies sisters bought French Impressionist art during a period when very few people were doing so.



You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 14–26, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.

Why we need silence

A Humans are finely attuned to noise, and for good reason. From an evolutionary perspective, sounds give us vital information, helping us navigate the world and avoid danger. To help ensure loud or unexpected noises get the attention they deserve, our internal chemistry alters in response to them. Our blood pressure goes up, muscles tense and glands release hormones that prepare us for fight or flight. In the short term, this is a good thing. When we are exposed to too much noise over the long term, however, those responses can lead to a multitude of health issues, from sleep disturbance to even cardiovascular disease.

B The World Health Organization has recently designated excessive noise as an 'underestimated threat' to public health, and has said that people living in cities such as Mumbai, Tokyo and Buenos Aires are being exposed to far more than the recommended 40 decibels of noise at night. A report from the European Environment Agency concluded that noise was an ongoing and widespread issue in Europe, with at least 1 in 5 people consistently exposed to levels considered harmful to health. 'There are no "earlids" that can protect your brain from noise,' says Nick Antonio, an acoustic consultant who has contributed to the British and international standards for noise.

C The good news is that several cities have been working to turn the volume down. One of the first to do so was London. 'By providing recommendations for quieter buses, reducing noise from roads and also controlling noise from aircraft, they were able to make the city quieter,' says Antonio. Other cities have introduced noise-reducing road coatings, for instance, alongside greenery that muffles sound. Some solutions are more specific: Washington DC's ban on petrol-powered leaf blowers came into effect recently, while in New York City, legislation has been approved to fine people who modify their vehicles to make them noisier. 'People are seeing the benefits of these more quiet environments in their cities,' Antonio says. 'I expect we will see much more of this in the future.'

D Researchers are also seeking to understand what aspects of silent experiences are most beneficial to our health. One of the best-researched is the flotation tank: a lightproof, soundproof tank of salt water in which a person floats as a form of deep relaxation. While some people experience altered perception in the tanks, involving subtle humming sounds and visual effects, these effects are benign and do not detract from the benefits of the experience, says Justin Feinstein, a clinical neuropsychologist. 'When you don't have external sensory stimuli coming in, the brain tries to fill the void to make sense of this dark and silent world,' he explains. 'In these tanks, some people can even hear the sound of their eyes blinking,' says Feinstein. 'But it is the ability to focus on the breath that helps people reach a relaxed or meditative state.'

E To further explore flotation tanks as a therapeutic tool, Feinstein and his colleagues recruited 50 people with a variety of conditions related to stress and had them answer a questionnaire prior to and following a flotation session. Participants reported decreases in muscle tension, pain and symptoms of their conditions after a single, 1-hour float, alongside an increase in feelings of relaxation and overall wellbeing.

Less is known about what effects sensory deprivation can have on the brain. To investigate, Feinstein's team had 48 people participate in either three 90-minute float sessions or three 90-minute periods of relaxing on a chair which reclined. Participants had their brains scanned using functional magnetic resonance imaging at the beginning and end of the trial. Float sessions uniquely decreased activity in the default mode network (DMN), a collection of brain regions commonly linked with depression. Feinstein says it is an exciting finding, because flotation tanks seem to offer a way of 'resetting' our nervous system to prevent it from getting out of balance.

F Neurobiologist Tal Dotan Ben-Soussan is also an advocate of silence as a therapy. 'When we find ways to be quiet, we are not only quiet in our environment, but quiet in our inner selves,' she explains. 'This allows us to be more aware of

what is happening around us and what the situation may require from us so we can provide [a more

Not everyone will benefit from silence to the same extent, but Ben-Soussan says one characteristic is key: the person must need to want to engage in the experience. 'We see from animal models and human studies that volition and intentionality is important,' she says. 'When people do not want silence, it can be very distressing.'

G Eric Pfeifer, a psychotherapy researcher, also concedes that some people may not benefit from silence, particularly those who are in a heightened state of stress. 'People in these states may not be able to relax or calm down in a silent condition,' he says. Professional guidance can be useful, he adds, allowing people to approach silence slowly so that they can gradually enjoy the benefits. And Pfeifer is convinced that silence is more attainable in everyday life than people think. First, complete silence isn't necessary. In a recent study, he found that participants reported more relaxation and less boredom when they sat quietly in an outdoor garden compared with a completely silent room. Second, Pfeifer believes we don't need a lot of silence to gain benefits. 'You don't need to spend hours in silence,' he says. 'It is likely better to have more frequency of silence for a few minutes at a time than a longer period of silence only once a week. Just finding those places in your daily life where you can find some silence ... can make a big difference.'

PART 2 — QUESTIONS

Part 2

Questions 14-17

Reading Passage 2 has seven sections, A-G.

Which section contains the following information?

14 examples of strategies to decrease the noise that the public are exposed to

15 data indicating the extent of the problem of excessive noise

16 a description of physiological changes in our bodies when we hear sudden noises

17 evidence that a relatively quiet environment can be more beneficial than a totally silent one

Questions 18-21

Complete the summary below.

Choose ONE WORD ONLY from the passage for each answer.

Flotation Tanks

According to Justin Feinstein, flotation tanks allow people to concentrate on their own **18** 18, which helps them relax and enables them to meditate.

Feinstein and his colleagues conducted an experiment in which 50 people, who were all suffering from stress and related issues, were given a **19** 19 to complete before and after using a flotation tank.

Participants reported a reduction in their symptoms after an hour in the tank, together with signs of relaxation and improved general **20** 20.

In another experiment, the researchers had 48 people spend periods of 90 minutes either lying back in a chair or floating in a tank. Brain scans then revealed that those people who had been in a tank had decreased activity in parts of the brain associated with **21** 21 .

Questions 22-26

Look at the following statements and the list of people below. Match each statement with the correct person, **A, B, C or D**.

NB You may use any letter more than once.

- A. Nick Antonio
- B. Justin Feinstein
- C. Tal Dotan Ben-Soussan
- D. Eric Pfeifer

22 It is unpleasant and upsetting for people to be placed in a silent environment against their will.

23 The trend towards creating quieter urban locations is likely to increase in the coming years.

24 When our body's senses are completely deprived of input, our minds compensate for this by creating the illusion of images and sounds.

25 Even a short amount of silent time can have a positive impact.

26 External and internal quietness makes us more conscious of events occurring in our surroundings and helps us react appropriately to these events.



You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 27–40, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.

Book review: The World of Sugar by Ulbe Bosma

Ulbe Bosma's *The World of Sugar* is a genuinely global history. Bosma discusses all the sugar-growing places of the world, beginning with Cuba and Java, the largest exporters of the early 20th century. But this is a history not just of cane sugar but also of beet sugar, an equally important form of traded sugar over the last hundred years. Beet sugar is grown mainly in Europe and the United States. It has also been massively subsidised and sold at artificially low prices on world markets, threatening the livelihood of producers of cane sugar.

Bosma's discussion of the sugar market in Britain gives a sense of the book's range. The sweet-toothed British first bought cane sugar from their own slavery-dependent colonial plantations. Following the abolition of slavery in the British Empire, cane sugar was imported to Britain from places which retained the practice, such as Cuba and Brazil. Towards the end of the 19th century, the British started to import beet sugar from continental Europe. Only in the 20th century was there a move to develop a national beet sugar industry.

The book provides a global labour history, investigating the wide range of labour regimes associated with growing sugar. Contrary to popular belief, cane sugar production was never just restricted to large, dedicated plantations owned by rich men. For example, in Java, a huge exporter of sugar in the early 20th century, sugar cane was grown together with rice in an extraordinarily labour-intensive way by small farmers.

The World of Sugar is also a story of similarity and continuity in sugar cultivation. For example, imported labour has been used for much large-scale production. German beet fields employed Polish workers; Mexicans and many others, including Sicilians, were vital to US sugar production. Cane cutting, Bosma shows, remains a poorly paid and brutal business to this day in many places in the world. But as well as this, the book is about the continuity of the use of traditional methods on small farms. In the mid 20th-century, this type of sugar production dominated in South Asia and Latin America.

This is also a history of capitalists and sugar dynasties, as well as corporations that in some cases have remained influential over very long periods. Great firms and great interests have had profound influence on the policies of states. In many places - not just the British Caribbean but Cuba and the Philippines too - a powerful sugar bourgeoisie played a major role in politics and their interests were consequently protected by trade barriers and subsidies. In the battle for control of the industry, it was inevitably the poor countries which came off worse. All this is explored by Bosma with wonderful subtlety and control.

But sugar production was never just a matter of agriculture. It also involved the extraction, close to the place of harvest, of sucrose from the sugar plant, a process which required machinery powered by humans, animals, wind or steam. Further processes involved boiling (from the 19th century, this often involved vacuum systems) and the separation of sugar from other materials in a process known as refinement. From very early on, sugar production was an energy-intensive industrial process, mostly taking place in the countryside and in refineries in centres of consumption, both small and large. The growth of the industry entailed a very rapid diffusion of ideas and techniques from one country to another. Cuba, for example, developed an extraordinarily dense system of railways to transport workers and cane, as well as steam-powered sugar factories. Particular varieties of cane sugar and beet sugar spread very rapidly across the world, in accordance with local needs and demands.

Where once only tiny quantities of sugar could be produced, now new techniques, varieties, fertilisers, irrigation systems and much more have turned gleaming white sugar into a ubiquitous chemical. Over the same time, there has been a massive increase in consumption. Once regarded as a luxury, sugar came to be promoted as a valuable source of energy. But as the consumption of sugar has increased, so has the harm it does, whether to people's teeth or weight. In the face of appalling obstruction from the sugar industry to attempts to reduce consumption, some countries have been forced to tax sugar in order to bring that about. The sugar industry has a history of attacking its critics and, when it comes to obesity, of trying to blame fats, and lack of exercise and self-control. And the recent past has seen worrying new developments in mass sweetening. High-fructose corn syrup made from maize using an enzymatic process invented in Japan in the 1960s has a similar number of calories to table sugar but is far cheaper to produce. It is now widely consumed, having been adopted in the making of soft drinks and a large number of processed foods, and is regarded as a leading cause of obesity.

This is a wonderfully rich book, a model of global history, the history of production and the history of capitalism. Bosma avoids outbursts of emotion, celebratory or critical, even if they might have made his analysis of the multiple tragedies involving sugar all the more powerful. He shows that we could always have done without sugar and that today we have many alternative sources of sweetness. Yet many of the poorest people in the world still depend on it to make a living.

PART 3 — QUESTIONS

Part 3

Questions 27-30

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** or **D**.

27 What does the reviewer suggest about the cultivation and trading of sugar in the first paragraph?

- A** Sugar has played a major role in international relations.
- B** Beet sugar has been made more internationally competitive.
- C** Cane sugar is thought to be of superior quality to beet sugar.
- D** New locations for cultivating sugar have increased production.

28 In the second paragraph, when discussing the sugar market in Britain, the reviewer stresses

- A** how the sources used changed over time.
- B** how developments in agriculture affected trade.
- C** the increased demand for sugar over the years.
- D** the growing support for ethical methods of cultivation.

29 What is the reviewer doing in the third paragraph?

- A** describing an efficient approach to sugar cultivation
- B** explaining why the use of sugar plantations declined
- C** addressing a misconception about the growing of sugar cane
- D** evaluating different approaches to the cultivation of sugar cane

30 In the final paragraph, what does the reviewer suggest is the overall message of Bosma's book?

- A** Sugar is a harmful and unnecessary product.
- B** Economic pressure is needed to control sugar production.
- C** Conditions for workers in sugar production should be improved.
- D** Intensive marketing of sugar has had disastrous consequences.

Questions 31-36

- A. national governments
- B. agricultural developments
- C. refers to 'less wealthy nations'
- D. untrained workers
- E. small-scale cultivation
- F. outdated methods
- G. financial controls
- H. refers to 'migrant workers'
- I. powerful individuals and business

Complete the summary using the list of words, A-I, below.

Sugar cultivation and production

The book *The World of Sugar* points out the similarities in the way that sugar was cultivated around the world. In the big industries in both Germany and the US, sugar farming depended on **31** However, in other parts of the world such as South Asia and Latin America, **32** continued.

Sugar production has also involved **33** who were eager to protect their markets. In countries such as Cuba the sugar industry therefore had a major influence on **34**

To support the interests of sugar producers, **35** were established. As a result of this, **36** were penalised.

Questions 37-40

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

- YES** if the statement agrees with the views of the writer
NO if the statement contradicts the views of the writer
NOT GIVEN if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

YES	if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer
NO	if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer
NOT GIVEN	if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

37 Sugar has now become available in large quantities due to a range of agricultural developments.

.....

38 Advertisers initially marketed sugar as a luxury product.

.....

39 The invention of high-fructose corn syrup was a positive development.

40 High-fructose corn syrup is an ingredient in many processed foods.

ANSWER KEY

Answer Key & Explanations

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
1	mining	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage states that the man who made the family wealthy, David Davies, earned his money from shipping goods and working in the mining business. Answer Explanation: The answer "mining" refers to the industry of digging minerals, like coal or metal, out of the ground. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is "mining" because the passage explicitly states that the sisters' grandfather, David Davies, became very rich (he "amassed a fortune") through his work in two specific areas: the shipping and mining industries. In the given notes, "shipping" is equivalent to "transportation businesses," making "mining" the missing word for the other industry.
2	education	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that although their family did not collect art before them, the sisters' school and training were carefully planned to prepare them for activities like collecting art. Answer Explanation: The answer refers to the learning and training the sisters received when they were young. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'education' because the passage states that even though their family didn't have a background in collecting art, their schooling and training were specifically 'geared toward' or designed for that activity. The word 'pursuits' in the passage refers back to 'art collecting' mentioned earlier in the same sentence.
3	notes	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that during their travels with their teacher (governess), the sisters visited art museums and wrote down many details about the paintings they saw. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'notes', which refers to the written records the sisters made while looking at art. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'notes' because the passage mentions that the sisters visited art galleries with their governess and took 'extensive notes' on the collections they saw. In this context, 'extensive' is a synonym for 'lengthy', and 'notes' describes the written information they recorded about the artwork.
4	journals	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage states that the sisters' private notebooks show which type of art they liked most. It also explains that these specific types of

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		paintings cost a lot of money, which is why they were difficult to buy. Answer Explanation: The answer journals refers to the notebooks where the sisters wrote down their personal thoughts and feelings. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is journals because the text mentions that these writings showed (revealed) that the sisters liked (had a preference for) Old Master paintings. The passage also explains that these paintings were too expensive, using the phrase 'beyond their means' or more than they were 'willing to pay'.
5	venice	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that when the sisters first began buying Impressionist art in October 1912, the paintings they bought were pictures of Venice. Answer Explanation: The answer is the city of Venice. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is Venice because the passage states that the sisters' first Impressionist paintings, which they bought in 1912, showed scenes of this specific city. These artworks were created by the famous French artist Claude Monet.
6	canteen	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that during the war, both Gwendoline and Margaret went to a town in France to help in a room where soldiers could get food and drink. Answer Explanation: The answer "canteen" refers to the specific type of place where the sisters offered their time for free to help the military during the war. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is "canteen" because the passage explains that during the First World War, both sisters chose to volunteer their time in France. It explicitly mentions they worked at a "canteen for troops." In this context, "troops" is another word for "soldiers," which matches the description in the notes.
7	friends	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that people notice the sisters lived alone in a quiet part of Wales and did not have personal relationships with artists or the people who own art galleries. Answer Explanation: The answer "friends" refers to people that you know well and like, but who are not members of your family. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is "friends" because the passage mentions that people who comment on the sisters' lives often talk about how they lived far away from others and did not have close social connections with people in the art world. Specifically, it states they did not make friends with artists. The word "friends" fits perfectly into the sentence describing why they were not seen as typical or expected art collectors.
8	True	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that the way the sisters grew up made them want to help society, so they spent the wealth they received (their inheritance) on goals like art and helping people. Answer Explanation: The answer is TRUE because the story says that how the sisters were raised as children made them want to use their money for helpful things. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is TRUE. The text mentions that the sisters had a "religious upbringing," which describes their childhood and how they were raised. This background gave them a important feeling called a "sense of social responsibility," meaning they felt they had a duty to help others. Because of this feeling from their youth, they decided to spend their "inheritance"—which is a large amount of money they received from their family—on "cultural and philanthropic purposes," such as art and charity.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
9	Not Given	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage confirms that the sisters bought paintings by a French artist named Corot, but it does not provide any details about the shop, gallery, or country where they got them. Answer Explanation: The answer "NOT GIVEN" means that the information provided in the text is not enough to decide if the statement is true or false. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is "NOT GIVEN" because the passage mentions that the sisters bought paintings by Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot as part of their early collection, but it never says where they bought them. Even though the sisters often visited France and bought other art there later, we cannot assume the Corot paintings were purchased from a gallery in France based on the text.
10	False	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that Hugh Blaker supported modern French art and played a role in helping the sisters decide to start buying it. Answer Explanation: The answer is FALSE because Hugh Blaker did not try to stop the sisters from buying French Impressionist art; instead, he supported and helped make that choice. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is FALSE because the passage states that Hugh Blaker was a 'champion' of contemporary French art, meaning he was a strong supporter and advocate for it. Furthermore, it explicitly says he 'had a hand in the decision' to buy French Impressionist works, which is the exact opposite of opposing it. In this context, to 'have a hand in' means he was involved in or influenced the choice to move in that direction.
11	Not Given	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage confirms that these specific paintings were the very first ones by this artist to be shown in a British public gallery. However, it says nothing about whether the public enjoyed the show or if it was famous. Answer Explanation: The answer is NOT GIVEN because the text tells us that the paintings were shown to the public, but it does not say if people liked them or if many people went to see them. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is NOT GIVEN because while the text mentions that Cézanne's paintings were put on display in a public gallery in Bath, it provides no information regarding the public's reaction or the level of popularity of the exhibition. To confirm if it was 'popular,' the text would need to mention things like 'many visitors' or 'great success,' but these details are absent. Therefore, we cannot determine if the statement is true or false based only on the passage.
12	True	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that Gwendoline felt bad about spending money on art because the war had made many people very poor and caused a lot of trouble in society. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the First World War changed how Gwendoline felt about buying art, leading her to stop collecting it. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is TRUE because the passage explicitly states that the poverty and social problems caused by the First World War made Gwendoline feel 'uncomfortable' about continuing to buy expensive paintings. This emotional and moral shift caused her to change her focus toward helping people and social causes. This change in her interests is confirmed by the fact that she made her final art purchase in 1926. Key terms include 'uncomfortable', which shows her change in feeling, and 'social upheaval', which refers to the big troubles in society caused by the war.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
13	True	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that when the sisters were building their art collection, almost everyone else—including private people and large groups like museums—paid no attention to French Impressionist paintings. Answer Explanation: The answer means that it is true that most people and organizations did not buy or care about French Impressionist art at the time the Davies sisters were collecting it. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is TRUE because the passage states that the sisters bought this type of art when it was "routinely ignored" by both individuals and institutions. The word "ignored" shows that other people were not paying attention to or buying these paintings, which matches the idea that very few people were doing so during that period.
14	C	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage gives several examples of things cities do to be less noisy, like using quiet buses, fixing roads, using plants to soak up sound, and creating rules against loud machines and loud car parts. Answer Explanation: The answer means that Section C is the part of the text that describes different plans and rules cities use to make life quieter for people. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is section C because it provides a list of several methods or 'strategies' used to lower sound levels. These include making buses quieter, using special road surfaces, planting trees to block sound, and passing laws against loud tools and modified cars. These examples directly address the 'strategies to decrease the noise' mentioned in the question.
15	B	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage uses a specific statistic—"1 in 5 people"—as data to explain that a large number of people are dealing with noise levels that can hurt their health. Answer Explanation: The answer is Section B, because this part of the text gives numbers and facts to show how big the problem of loud noise is. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is B because it provides specific "data" or statistics to show the "extent" (how widespread and serious) of the "problem of excessive noise." It includes information from global organizations like the World Health Organization and the European Environment Agency. Key phrases that indicate the scale of the problem include "40 decibels" and "1 in 5 people," which prove that noise is a common and harmful issue.
16	A	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that when we hear a loud or surprising noise, the chemicals inside our bodies change. It says our blood pressure rises, our muscles get tight, and our body sends out special chemicals (hormones) to help us deal with the situation. Answer Explanation: The answer is Section A because it describes the physical ways our bodies react to loud or surprising sounds. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is A because this section lists several 'physiological changes'—which are physical changes inside the body—that happen when we hear sudden or loud sounds. It mentions that our 'internal chemistry' changes, our 'blood pressure' increases, our 'muscles' become tight, and our bodies release 'hormones' to get us ready for action. These details match the description of bodily changes mentioned in the question.
17	G	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that research showed people felt more calm and less tired of their surroundings when they were in a quiet garden instead of a room that was 100% silent.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		Answer Explanation: The answer identifies Section G as the part of the text that shows why a place with a little bit of sound can be better for a person than a place with no sound at all. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is G because it describes a study by Eric Pfeifer. In this study, he looked at how people feel in different environments. He found that people felt more relaxed and had a better time in an outdoor garden, which is quiet but not silent, than they did in a room that was completely silent. This provides the evidence that a relatively quiet place can be more beneficial than a totally silent one.
18	breath	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage tells us that when a person pays attention to their breathing, it allows them to become very calm and relax their mind. Answer Explanation: The answer means the air that you take into your body and let out when you are breathing. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'breath' because the passage in paragraph D explains that focusing on this specific action is what allows people to become calm. In the summary, the phrase 'concentrate on' is used, which has the same meaning as 'focus on' in the text. The passage confirms that this focus is what helps a person reach a 'relaxed or meditative state'.
19	questionnaire	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage states that researchers looked for 50 people with stress and asked them to fill out a questionnaire before and after they stayed in the tank to see if they felt better. Answer Explanation: The answer refers to a list of written questions used to collect information from people about their health and feelings. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'questionnaire' because the passage mentions it as the specific tool used to gather data from the 50 participants before and after their time in the tank. The text uses the phrase 'answer a questionnaire' to describe what the participants did to report on their stress-related conditions. Key terms to note are '50 people', 'stress', and 'answer'.
20	wellbeing	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that after spending one hour in a flotation tank, people felt better physically and mentally, reporting that their general health and happiness (wellbeing) improved. Answer Explanation: The answer refers to the general state of feeling healthy, happy, and comfortable. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'wellbeing' because the passage describes a study where people used a flotation tank for one hour. After the session, the participants said they felt less pain and stress, had more feelings of relaxation, and noticed an increase in their 'overall wellbeing.' In the summary, the word 'general' is used as a synonym for 'overall.'

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
21	depression	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that using the flotation tank made a specific part of the brain less active. It then explains that these same brain areas are usually connected to the illness of depression. Answer Explanation: The answer 'depression' refers to a mental health condition where a person feels very sad and loses interest in things they usually enjoy. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'depression' because the passage explains a study where 48 people either sat in a chair or used a flotation tank. The researchers used brain scans to see what happened to their brains. They found that the people who were in the tanks had less activity in a part of the brain called the 'default mode network' (DMN). The text clearly states that this specific group of brain regions is 'linked with depression.'
22	C	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that when people are in a quiet environment without wanting to be there, it can make them feel extremely upset or uncomfortable. Answer Explanation: The answer means that if a person is forced to be in a quiet place and they do not want to be there, they will feel very unhappy and upset. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is C because Tal Dotan Ben-Soussan explains that a person's choice to be in a silent environment is very important. She uses the words 'volition and intentionality' to describe this choice. She states that when people do not want to be in silence, it can be 'distressing,' which means it causes a lot of worry or pain. This matches the idea of silence being 'unpleasant and upsetting' when it is against someone's 'will' (their choice).
23	A	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that people like the good results of having less noise in their cities. Because of this, Nick Antonio believes that we will see many more of these quiet changes in the time ahead. Answer Explanation: The answer is A (Nick Antonio). Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is Nick Antonio because he suggests that the move towards making cities quieter will continue to grow. In the text, he points out that people are already noticing the positive effects of quieter urban areas. Using keywords like 'expect' and 'future,' he explains that he believes more cities will adopt these noise-reducing changes in the years to come.
24	B	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage states that when there is no information coming from our eyes or ears, the brain tries to give the person something to focus on by creating its own sounds and images. This happens because the brain is trying to understand a world that has become completely dark and quiet. Answer Explanation: The answer identifies Justin Feinstein as the researcher who explained that our brain creates imaginary sounds and sights when we are in a place with no sensory input. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is B because Justin Feinstein studies flotation tanks, which are designed to remove light and sound. He notes that when the brain has no 'external sensory stimuli' (information from the outside world), it tries to 'fill the void' (make up for the silence and darkness). This leads to 'altered perception,' where people might hear humming or see visual effects that are not actually there, which is the mind's way of compensating for the lack of input.
25	D	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that Pfeifer thinks we don't need to be quiet for a long time to stay healthy. He says it is better to find quiet for just a few minutes many times rather than being quiet for many hours only once a week.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		Answer Explanation: The answer means that Eric Pfeifer is the person who says that even a little bit of quiet time can be very helpful for people. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is D because Eric Pfeifer specifically says that we do not need to stay in silence for hours to get the benefits. He explains that having quiet moments for just a few minutes more often is better than one long period of silence. His mentions of 'a few minutes' and 'not a lot of silence' match the phrase 'short amount' in the question, and 'gain benefits' matches 'positive impact'.
26	C	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that when we are quiet both in the world around us and inside our own minds, we can pay more attention to what is happening near us and act in the way that the situation needs. Answer Explanation: The answer identifies Tal Dotan Ben-Soussan as the person who believes that having a quiet environment and a quiet mind helps us notice things better and react the right way. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is C because Tal Dotan Ben-Soussan explains the relationship between "quiet in our environment" (external) and being "quiet in our inner selves" (internal). She links this silence to being "more aware" (conscious) of what is happening "around us" (surroundings), which allows for an "adequate response" (reacting appropriately).
27	B	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that beet sugar gets a lot of financial support and is sold very cheaply across the world. This makes it harder for people who grow sugar cane to make enough money from their work. Answer Explanation: The answer means that beet sugar is given financial help so it can be sold at lower prices, making it easier to sell compared to other types of sugar around the world. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is B because the first paragraph explains that beet sugar receives a lot of government money (it is 'subsidised') and is sold at very low prices. This financial help allows beet sugar to compete better against cane sugar, even though those low prices are not natural ('artificially low'). Being more 'competitive' means it is easier to sell in the global market.
28	A	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage lists the different stages of where Britain bought its sugar over many years, showing how it moved from colonial plantations to foreign countries and then to its own local industry. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the places and ways Britain got its sugar changed as the years went by. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is A because the second paragraph explains the history of sugar in Britain by listing where it came from during different time periods. It describes a change from using their own colonies, to other countries like Brazil, and then switching from cane sugar to beet sugar from Europe and finally making it at home. The word 'sources' refers to these different countries and types of sugar, while 'changed over time' refers to the chronological sequence from the early 19th century into the 20th century.
29	C	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that, although most people believe sugar was only grown on huge farms owned by wealthy people, this was not actually the case. Answer Explanation: The answer means that in the third paragraph, the author is talking about a common wrong idea that people have about how sugar is grown.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is C because the author begins by mentioning a 'popular belief' and then shows why it is not completely true. This is what 'addressing a misconception' means. Many people think sugar cane was only grown on big plantations with rich owners, but the author uses an example from Java to show that small farmers grew it too. This proves that sugar production was not 'restricted' or limited to just one type of farm.
30	A	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that the author looks at many very sad events ("tragedies") caused by sugar. It also explains that people have never really needed sugar to survive and that there are other things we can use to make food sweet today. Answer Explanation: The answer means that according to the book's final thoughts, people do not actually need to use sugar, and it causes many bad problems for the world. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is A because the final paragraph highlights two main points that reflect the overall message. First, it mentions the "multiple tragedies involving sugar," which relates to the word 'harmful'. Second, it explicitly states that humans "could always have done without sugar," which means it was never a 'necessary' product. While the book mentions that poor people depend on it for jobs, the reviewer's summary of the author's analysis identifies sugar as something we don't need and that has caused great sadness or harm.
31	H. refers to 'migrant workers'	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that the large sugar industries in Germany and the United States did not use local workers alone; instead, they hired people from other countries like Poland, Mexico, and Italy (Sicily) to do the work. Answer Explanation: The answer 'H' refers to 'migrant workers', which are people who move from one country or region to another to find work, often in farming. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is found by looking at the examples provided in the passage regarding Germany and the US. The text mentions that German farms used workers from Poland, and US sugar production relied on workers from Mexico and Sicily. These groups—Polish, Mexican, and Sicilian workers—are all examples of people moving to a different country to work, which is why the term 'migrant workers' is the most accurate fit for the summary.
32	E. small-scale cultivation	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that sugar was still made using old ways on small pieces of land. During the middle of the 1900s, this was the main way sugar was produced in South Asia and Latin America. Answer Explanation: The answer 'small-scale cultivation' refers to the practice of growing crops on small pieces of land, often managed by individual farmers or families rather than large corporations. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'small-scale cultivation' because the passage explains that while large-scale production used imported labor, there was also a 'continuity' (meaning something that stays the same) of 'traditional methods on small farms'. It specifically mentions that 'this type of sugar production' (referring to small farms) was the most common form in South Asia and Latin America during the mid-20th century. Therefore, 'small-scale cultivation' is the best fit for the summary.
33	I. powerful individuals and business	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that rich business owners, powerful families (dynasties), and large companies (corporations) have been important for a long time. These strong groups (great firms) have used their power to change the rules made by governments. Answer Explanation: The answer identifies the group of people and companies that had a lot of money and power in the sugar industry.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is Choice I because the passage describes the history of sugar as a history of 'capitalists', 'sugar dynasties', 'corporations', and 'great firms'. These terms refer to powerful individuals (dynasties and capitalists) and businesses (corporations and firms) that used their influence to protect their business interests and markets by affecting government policies and trade rules.
34	A. national governments	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage states that in several locations, including Cuba, the wealthy people who owned the sugar industry were very involved in the political process. Because they were so active in politics, the government made rules like taxes on imports (trade barriers) and financial help (subsidies) to protect them. Answer Explanation: The answer 'national governments' refers to the political authorities and systems that rule a country. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is derived from the passage's mention of the 'sugar bourgeoisie' (powerful business owners) in countries like Cuba. It explains that these figures 'played a major role in politics,' which is a synonym for having influence over national governments. By being involved in politics, they could ensure that the laws and rules created by the government protected their interests. Keywords like 'politics' and 'major role' correspond to 'national governments' and 'major influence' respectively.
35	G. financial controls	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that in several countries, rich people who owned sugar businesses were very involved in the government. Because of this, the government made rules like taxes on foreign sugar or special payments to help those businesses stay successful. Answer Explanation: The answer 'financial controls' refers to government rules or laws that manage money, taxes, and how goods are traded. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'financial controls' because the passage explains that powerful sugar business owners influenced governments to protect their profits. They did this by using 'trade barriers and subsidies.' In this context, 'financial controls' is another way to describe these specific government actions like limiting imports (trade barriers) or providing money to help domestic businesses (subsidies).
36	C. refers to 'less wealthy nations'	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that when different groups fought to lead the sugar business, the countries with very little money were always the ones that lost or were hurt the most. Answer Explanation: The answer 'C' refers to 'less wealthy nations,' which are countries that do not have a lot of money or resources. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is chosen because the passage mentions that in the struggle for power within the sugar industry, 'poor countries' were the ones that suffered the most. In the summary, the word 'penalised' means they were put at a disadvantage or hurt by the rules. The term 'poor countries' used in the text is a synonym for 'less wealthy nations' in the options. This happened because powerful groups influenced politics to create trade rules that helped themselves but hurt those poorer nations.
37	Yes	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage states that while only a small amount of sugar could be made in the past, modern farming methods, different types of sugar plants, and systems to feed and water them have made white sugar very easy to find everywhere today. Answer Explanation: The answer YES means the statement is true according to the writer because sugar is now produced in very large amounts thanks to many different farming improvements.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is YES because the passage explains that sugar was once only made in small amounts, but it has now become common and available everywhere. The text mentions that this change happened because of different improvements like 'new techniques', 'varieties' (different types of plants), 'fertilisers', and 'irrigation systems'. Phrases like 'large quantities' in the question match the word 'ubiquitous' (meaning found everywhere) in the text.
38	Not Given	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that people used to think of sugar as a special, expensive treat. Later, it was advertised as a good way to get energy. However, it does not confirm if the first advertisements actually used the word 'luxury' to sell it. Answer Explanation: The answer is NOT GIVEN because the text does not tell us if the very first advertisements for sugar called it a luxury item. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is NOT GIVEN because while the text mentions that sugar was 'once regarded as a luxury', it does not say that advertisers were the ones who marketed it that way at the beginning. The passage explains that it was later 'promoted' as a source of energy, but it gives no information about the specific content of early advertisements regarding its status as a luxury.
39	No	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that this specific syrup is a 'worrying' new way to sweeten food. It also mentions that this syrup is a main reason for 'obesity,' which shows its effect on people's health is bad. Answer Explanation: The answer NO means that the writer disagrees with the statement; the writer does not think the invention of high-fructose corn syrup was a good or helpful thing. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is NO because the author describes high-fructose corn syrup as a 'worrying' change rather than a good one. The author also states it is a 'leading cause of obesity,' which is a serious health problem where people become unhealthily overweight. Because it causes harm and is described with negative words, the writer views its invention as a negative development.
40	Yes	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage states that this type of syrup is common today and is a main part of many soft drinks and many other factory-made foods. Answer Explanation: The answer YES means that the text confirms that high-fructose corn syrup is a part of many foods that are prepared in factories before they are sold. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is YES because the passage says that high-fructose corn syrup is used in a 'large number' of foods. In English, 'a large number' means almost the same as 'many'. The text explicitly links this syrup to 'processed foods', which matches the statement in the question exactly.